

Nic Grayson

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Summary

High-ownership **Staff / Principal Platform Engineer** specializing in developer leverage, end-to-end infrastructure abstractions, and high-velocity engineering loops. Proven track record of owning zero-to-one developer tools, optimizing CI/CD pipelines, and integrating containerized environments (Kubernetes/EKS, Tilt, Docker) with AI-native workflows (Claude Code, custom MCP servers). Driven by deep-dive problem solving, automated observability (Datadog), and empowering product engineers through maintainable platform design.

Experience

FICO | Remote

Principal Engineer / Technical Lead • May 2026 – Present

- **Platform & Infrastructure Integration:** Leading the post-acquisition migration and scaling of developer platform infrastructure, local inner-loops, and EKS cloud patterns across enterprise engineering groups.
- **AI-Native Engineering Abstractions:** Architected and deployed organization-wide Claude Code and Model Context Protocol (MCP) toolchains, building high-leverage abstractions that turn manual code generation, PR reviews, and testing into automated developer capabilities.

Great Expectations (Acquired by FICO) | Remote

Staff Cloud Engineer • June 2022 – May 2026

- **High-Leverage DevEx & Inner Loops:** Designed and maintained fast, live-reloading local development environments using **Tilt** and **Docker**, drastically reducing developer feedback loops prior to **Kubernetes (Amazon EKS)** deployment.
- **Autonomous Tooling & Sandboxing:** Sandboxed and integrated terminal-based AI agents with local container stacks, enabling automated build execution, unit testing, and interactive debugging within isolated environments.
- **Infrastructure as a Product:** Owned developer tooling end-to-end—treating the Kubernetes, Tilt, and CI/CD platform as an internal SaaS product to eliminate onboarding friction and maximize developer velocity.

Preset | Remote

Staff Cloud Infrastructure Engineer • October 2021 – June 2022

- **IaC & Centralized Observability:** Leveraged **Terraform** to provision scalable **AWS** infrastructure while engineering centralized **Datadog** telemetry, log aggregation, and alerting pipelines to shorten mean-time-to-resolution (MTTR) for product engineers.

American Family Insurance | Madison, WI

Principal Cloud Engineer • July 2017 – October 2021

- **AWS & Infrastructure Automation:** Automated AWS cloud infrastructure for data science and engineering teams using modular **Terraform** and ChatOps plugins.
- **Platform Operations:** Owned deployment, security enforcement, and maintenance for core internal developer platform services including **Kubernetes, GitLab, Datadog, Vault, Consul, and Artifactory.**

VMware | Remote

Senior Site Reliability Engineer • January 2017 – July 2017

- Maintained large-scale ELK stack observability pipelines running on Mesos for cloud application logging and metrics. Automated deployments using Terraform and Jenkins.

EMC | Remote

Infrastructure Automation Engineer • October 2015 – November 2016

- Built production-ready automated deployment frameworks on Mesos for multi-datacenter exabyte-scale object storage, Kafka, and telemetry systems.

Jack Henry & Associates | Des Moines, IA

Lead Infrastructure Engineer • July 2010 – October 2015

- Led the evolutionary migration of hosting infrastructure from manual shared hosting to Chef-automated clusters, Docker, and Mesos.

Technical Skills

- **Languages & Tools:** Python, Go, Bash, Terraform, Shell Scripting
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Kubernetes (EKS), Docker, Tilt, AWS, Cloud Networking, Infrastructure as Code (IaC)
- **DevEx & AI Tooling:** Claude Code CLI, Model Context Protocol (MCP), CI/CD Automation, Live-Reloading Inner Loops
- **Observability & Operations:** Datadog, ELK Stack, Vault, Consul, Telemetry, Incident Management

Education

- **University of Northern Iowa** — Bachelor of Arts (BA), Mathematics & Computer Science
- **North Iowa Area Community College** — Associate of Arts (AA), Mathematics Teacher Education